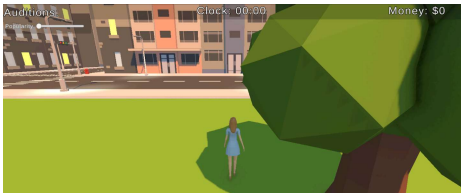
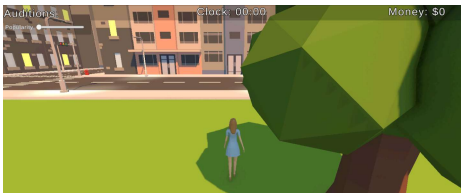
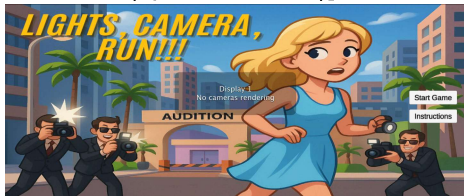


## Assignment 07: Alpha Release (UI, Sound, and Testing)

**UI Design:** Each team member identifies three instances in their checkpoint demo where principles of UI design

| Member  | Before                                                                              | After                                                                                | Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nandini |    |    | <p><b>What principle was broken in that instance?</b><br/> Minimizing Error Possibilities. Because we didn't provide a visual cue that there was something special about the taxi. If the player hit it by accident, they would randomly spawn elsewhere in the game.</p> <p><b>How did you fix that instance?</b><br/> By adding a green halo around the taxi so the user knows that it is not a regular vehicle</p> |
| Nandini |  |  | <p><b>What principle was broken in that instance?</b><br/> Clarity: It wasn't obvious at first glance that this is where the audition center is</p> <p><b>How did you fix that instance?</b><br/> I added signs to each studio and also a sign on the building saying that they are taking auditions</p>                                                                                                              |

|         |                                                                                     |                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nandini |    |    | <p><b>What principle was broken in that instance?</b></p> <p>Clarity - it isn't obvious that the player has reached the border of the city. Going past this area will make them fall infinitely, so we should stop them.</p> <p><b>How did you fix that instance?</b></p> <p>I added hedges so the player knows they have reached the city border</p> |
| Lora    |   |   | <p><b>What principle was broken in that instance?</b></p> <p>Clarity - it isn't obvious that players can interact with this</p> <p><b>How did you fix that instance?</b></p> <p>I added a circle marker to make it stand out</p>                                                                                                                      |
| Lora    |  |  | <p><b>What principle was broken in that instance?</b></p> <p>Feedback - The building stayed the same after completing an audition</p> <p><b>How did you fix that instance?</b></p> <p>I added a green door that closes after they player leaves the audition center to let them know that</p>                                                         |

|        |                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|        |                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                               | building is complete                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Lora   |    |                                                             | <p><b>What principle was broken in that instance?</b></p> <p>Feedback - buttons don't change when selecting one</p> <p><b>How did you fix that instance?</b></p> <p>Buttons change to their respective colors when you select it</p>                      |
| Vedant |    | <p>[Navigation arrow]</p>                                   | <p><b>What principle was broken in that instance?</b></p> <p>No way to know how to navigate to the goal</p> <p><b>How did you fix that instance?</b></p> <p>I added an arrow that points to the next goal in the game</p>                                 |
| Vedant |  | <p>[Provide users with instructions (splash screen)]</p>  | <p><b>What principle was broken in that instance?</b></p> <p>The game did not have an introduction or instructions for the controls</p> <p><b>How did you fix that instance?</b></p> <p>We added a game start screen with options to see instructions</p> |

|        |                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Vedant |  | <p>Paparazzi flashes light on contact with player to indicate a picture was taken</p>  | <p><b>What principle was broken in that instance?</b><br/>No way to tell if points were deducted in-game (apart from seeing money is reduced)</p> <p><b>How did you fix that instance?</b><br/>Paparazzi shine a camera flash to indicate a picture has been taken.</p> |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

**Sound Design:** The well-rated commercial game closest to ours [Mirror's Edge](#). These are the sounds we observed in the game:

1. Subtle background music (accepted): we added
  - a. **Where or when is taking place?**  
The music is taking place in the background
  - b. **How does it impact the visuals?**  
At the start, when the player is getting familiar with the environment, there's no music. But once the chase begins, the music becomes fast-paced, making the scene feel more intense and rushed.
  - c. **Why are they taking place? Why are some more obvious than others?**  
It adds tension and seriousness to the scene and helps the player focus on what's happening. It's more subtle than others because it's just adding a mood to the game. The sound has little to do with the actual gameplay.
  - d. **Are the sounds repetitive? If not, how were the game designers able to reduce it?**
  - e. Yes, the music is repetitive—just a beat playing over and over. But it's not very noticeable because it speeds up, slows down, or changes volume throughout the game.
  - f. **How was this sound created?**  
I assume it was professionally composed.
  - g. **Is it too loud or quiet?**  
It's quiet. Other sounds, like dialogue, collisions, and falling, are louder than the background music.
2. Collision into walls/doors sound (accepted): We added collision sounds when the player hits objects like cars to make it feel realistic, as if they're walking through a real city.

- a. **Where or when is taking place?**  
It takes place whenever the player pushes through the door or falls
  - b. **How does it impact the visuals?**  
The sound enhances the visuals. It adds realism by letting the player "feel" the force of the collision.
  - c. **Why are they taking place? Why are some more obvious than others?**  
The sound enhances the visuals. It adds realism by letting the player "feel" the force of the collision.
  - d. **Are the sounds repetitive?**  
Yes, but other sounds—like windows breaking, footsteps, and background music—blend with it, so the repetition isn't too noticeable.
  - e. **How was this sound created?**  
I think it was probably recorded by someone physically colliding with walls.
  - f. **Is it too loud or quiet?**  
The sound is just right
  
3. Triumphant music (accepted): we added this to our game because it gives feedback to the player that they are heading in the right direction and because of the emotional impact on the player, similar to Mirror's Edges
  - a. **Where or when is taking place:** when the main character reaches a major goal/ end of the level
  - b. **How does it impact the visuals:** the environment looks more intense
  - c. **Why are they taking place? Why are some more obvious than others?** the purpose is to emotionally impact the player and give them a sense of reward/ make it look like a greater achievement
  - d. **Are the sounds repetitive? If not, how were the game designers able to reduce it?:** It is not repetitive because it's used sparingly
  - e. **How was this sound created?:** It sounds like the main game music is swapped with this
  - f. **Is it too loud or quiet?:** No
  
4. Enemies talking (accepted): we added paparazzi chatter/noise that becomes louder the closer the player gets to them. This gives the player feedback that enemies are near them without having to look directly at them.
  - a. **Where or when is taking place:** when the player is near an enemy, you can sometimes hear them talking over the radios and communicating with each other
  - b. **How does it impact the visuals?** It might help the player by making the enemies stand out in the environment
  - c. **Why are they taking place? Why are some more obvious than others?** the purpose is to add immersion and life to the enemies while also reminding the player to watch out for enemies/ indicate that they are nearby.

- d. **Are the sounds repetitive? If not, how were the game designers able to reduce it?:** Only a little since the enemies speak the same phrases and use the same audio clips, but since not every enemy speaks, it isn't too repetitive.
  - e. **How was this sound created?:** The enemy objects were assigned to play a clip from a list of voice recordings, and an enemy is picked at random to play a clip once in a while
  - f. **Is it too loud or quiet?:** No
  
- 5. Countdown (Accepted): We added a countdown timer when the game is approaching its end as a form of feedback so the user knows to hurry up.
  - a. **Where or when is taking place:** At the final hour of the day
  - b. **How does it impact the visuals?** Makes everything feel more frantic and pairs well with visual timers.
  - c. **Why are they taking place? Why are some more obvious than others?** To warn the player that time is almost up. It's obvious because it must grab attention.
  - d. **Are the sounds repetitive? If not, how were the game designers able to reduce it?:** Yes, it's a looping beep
  - e. **How was this sound created?:** Imported from the internet
  - f. **Is it too loud or quiet?:** It's noticeable but not overpowering — just right to raise tension.
  
- 6. Walking, Running, Jumping Sounds (accepted): We added different footstep and movement sounds to make our world feel grounded and physical — just like Mirror's Edge.
  - a. **Where or when is taking place:** Whenever the player walks, runs, or jumps.
  - b. **How does it impact the visuals?** It adds realism and makes animation feel responsive and alive.
  - c. **Why are they taking place? Why are some more obvious than others?** To reflect different movement speeds and actions.
  - d. **Are the sounds repetitive? If not, how were the game designers able to reduce it?:** Only repetitive as long as the running or walking is happening. The jumping sound is one time.
  - e. **How was this sound created?:** Imported from the internet
  - f. **Is it too loud or quiet?:** Low — blends well with the environment.

7. Intense Chase Music (accepted) - We added this to signal the start of a chase when the paparazzi spot and begin pursuing the player. Like in Mirror's Edge, it builds tension and creates a sense of urgency and motion.
  - a. **Where or when is taking place:** As soon as the player is spotted, the chase begins.
  - b. **How does it impact the visuals?** Makes everything feel faster and more intense — the player starts to feel the pressure to escape.
  - c. **Why are they taking place? Why are some more obvious than others?** This is to alert the player that they're in danger and must react quickly. It's obvious by design to trigger an immediate response.
  - d. **Are the sounds repetitive? If not, how were the game designers able to reduce it?:** Slightly repetitive, but only present when a chase is active.
  - e. **How was this sound created?:** Imported from the internet
  - f. **Is it too loud or quiet?:** Slightly louder — just enough to dominate the scene without overpowering all other sounds.

Sounds we created for our game:

1. NPC sounds -> Nandini
  - a. What: sounds of fans screaming in joy
  - b. How: Whenever the celebrity is near the fans, this sound will be heard
2. Money sounds whenever you collide with a taxi or clothing store -> Nandini & Lora
  - a. What: sounds of cashier-register "ka-ching"
  - b. How: Whenever you collide with a taxi or change your dress to disguise yourself, you will hear this sound because you are spending money that you earned from the game
3. (Audition completion sound) → Lora:
  - a. What: audience applause plays when the player completes an audition
  - b. How: used a box collider to detect when the player enters the audition zone, which then plays the audio
4. Countdown when the timer is almost ending → Vedant
  - a. What: This is a ticking noise that alerts the player that time is running out
  - b. How: This sound plays when you approach midnight in the game.
5. Subtle background music → Nandini:
  - a. What: This is just upbeat music that sets the mood of the game
  - b. How: This was added by adding an Audio source to a game object
6. (Triumphant music) – Lora:
  - a. What: when the player is near the audition center
  - b. How: added a large box collider surrounding the audition center that plays 20th-century Fox music when the player steps inside the zone
7. Walking, Running, Jumping sound → Vedant
  - a. What: The sound of heels for walking and running and a grunting noise for the jumps

- b. How: Depending on the current action being performed by the player (walking, jumping, or running) one of the above sounds will be played
- 8. (Traffic Noises) → Lora:
  - a. What: cars honk at the player if they walk in front of them
  - b. How: used a ray cast to detect players that cross it, which then plays the honking audio
- 9. Paparazzi chase music → Vedant
  - a. What and How: Intense background music when a paparazzi starts to chase (as opposed to the soft subtle, normal background sound)

**Our tester for other teams:** Vedant